

Decree of Shuttered Lamps Concerning the Lantern Moth Swarm

Let this word be read beneath roof, tower, wall, and watchfire.

The **Lantern Moth Swarm** is declared a siege-breaker of serious threat. No keeper of a gate, no master of a fortification, and no soldier entrusted with a defended position shall mistake its quiet approach for harmless night-weather. When the swarm comes, it does not come as a beast that may be struck down and left behind. Acting as a collective, it brings mothlike disruption against fortified positions, troubling sight, order, signal, and courage together.

Its appearance shall be known and feared: a dense cloud of moths carrying the eerie visual impression of lantern-light. Let no sentry call that glow a friendly lamp. Let no captain order a gate opened because pale lights gather beyond the wall. Let no weary hand reach toward the cloud in hope of finding a road, a torch, or a rescuer within it.

The demeanor of the **Lantern Moth Swarm** is restless, overwhelming, and difficult to escape. Therefore, when such a cloud is seen near a fortified position, all persons are commanded to preserve their breath, guard their eyes, and obey the nearest uncontested order. Bells, horns, and shouted warnings are to be used according to the custom of the garrison, but none shall presume that noise will master the swarm. No one is to scatter without direction. No one is to pursue lights that move against the wind or vanish behind stone.

Watchers shall report the sighting plainly, naming the **Lantern Moth Swarm** without ornament, boast, or disbelief. A messenger who calls it mist may bring death to those who prepare for mist. A guard who calls it fire may draw men toward it. A guard who calls it nothing shall answer for the silence, if any answer remains possible.

Walls are raised to deny entry, not to grant courage. The swarm is known to bring its disruption against those walls, and all defenders shall understand that stone alone is not victory. Maintain sealed passages where possible. Keep the unblinded near the blinded. Recover neither fallen weapon nor abandoned lantern while the cloud remains in reach.

This decree is to be kept with the watch orders and read whenever the lamps burn strangely. Let the timid call the warning superstition. The wise will call it preparation. The **Lantern Moth Swarm** does not require belief before it arrives.